
A PRACTICAL GUIDE FOR BUILDERS, BROKERS & AGENCIES · INDIA · 2026

The Real Estate Website Blueprint

What a property website actually needs to turn a stranger scrolling at 11pm into a site visit on Sunday — and what to prepare before you pay anyone to build it.

78%

of buyers go with the first business that responds

53%

of mobile visitors leave a site that takes over 3 seconds

15 hrs

average response time to a property enquiry

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The 10-minute misunderstanding

A website can be built in ten minutes now. That is real — AI-assisted workflows have collapsed the build time for a premium property site from six weeks to an afternoon. But nobody is paying for the ten minutes.

They are paying for the decisions made before those ten minutes: which three things go above the fold, what the enquiry form asks and what it deliberately does not, where the WhatsApp button sits, what happens in the ninety seconds after someone submits, and which of your projects gets the homepage. Speed is now a commodity. Judgement is not.

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS

The decision list. Everything you should have settled before a single page gets designed — whether you build it yourself, hire an agency, or get it done in an afternoon. Work through it and you will get a better website from anyone you hire.

Who it is for

- Builders and developers launching or re-launching a project site
- Brokers and channel partners who currently run everything through Instagram DMs and 99acres
- Agencies and freelancers who build property sites for clients and want a checklist that makes the client look organised

How to use it

- 01** Read Sections 1–3 to fix what the site is for. Most bad property websites are bad because this was never decided.
- 02** Use Sections 4–7 as the build spec — hand them to whoever is building.
- 03** Section 8 is the one that actually makes you money. It is about what happens after the form is submitted, not before.
- 04** Section 10 is your prep checklist. Gather that material first and any build gets faster and better.

What the website is actually for

A property website has exactly one job: convert attention into a conversation. Everything else — the animations, the drone footage, the awards row — is either helping that or getting in the way.

The three jobs, in order

- 01** Prove you are real. Property is a high-trust, high-value purchase. A visitor is deciding in seconds whether you are a serious developer or a WhatsApp-forward scam. Stanford's web credibility research found roughly 75% of people judge an organisation's credibility on its website design alone.
- 02** Answer the four questions fast. Where is it? What does it cost? What is the configuration? When is possession? Every extra click before these answers loses people.
- 03** Make contact effortless and immediate. One tap to WhatsApp, one tap to call, one short form. Then respond in minutes, not hours.

A property website is not a brochure with a scrollbar. A brochure informs. A website has to start a conversation, at 11pm, without you.

What it is not for

- ✗ Listing every project you have ever completed in equal weight
- ✗ Winning a design award
- ✗ The chairman's two-page message (put it on the About page if it must exist)
- ✗ Explaining your company history before the visitor knows what you are selling

Why most property websites get zero leads

Not because they look bad. Most of them look fine. They fail on structure and follow-up.

The problem	What it costs you
Hero section says the brand name and nothing else	The visitor still does not know the location, price band or configuration after 8 seconds
Price is hidden behind "Enquire for details"	Serious buyers filter you out; you collect enquiries from people who were never in your budget
Enquiry form asks for 8 fields including a message box	Every extra field costs completions — especially on a phone, one-handed, on mobile data
No WhatsApp option	In India, WhatsApp is the default channel for a first, low-commitment question
Site takes 6–9 seconds to load because of an uncompressed hero video	53% of mobile visitors abandon past 3 seconds (Google/SOASTA); bounce probability rises 32% between 1s and 3s
No RERA number visible	A legal problem and a trust problem at the same time
Enquiries land in an inbox nobody watches	Documented average response time to a property enquiry is over 15 hours; roughly half get no reply at all
Gallery is 30 renders with no floor plan and no location map	Buyers cannot self-qualify, so they do not enquire

Notice that six of these eight are decisions, not code. That is why the build time is not the expensive part.

The first screen

You get one screen before the visitor decides to scroll or leave. It must carry five things and nothing else.

- 01** Project name + one-line positioning. "3 & 4 BHK residences on Sultanpur Road" beats "Redefining luxury living". Say the thing.
- 02** Location, stated plainly. The locality name a local person would use, not the marketing name.
- 03** Price band or starting price. Even "Starting ₹68L*" filters your enquiries into people who can actually buy. Hiding it does not create desire; it creates dropout.
- 04** One primary action. Not four. Either "Get price & floor plans on WhatsApp" or "Book a site visit" — pick the one your sales process is actually ready for.
- 05** One trust marker. RERA number, possession date, or "Delivered 6 projects since 2011". Small text, big effect.

Rules for the hero

- The primary action must be visible without scrolling on a phone, not just on your laptop.
- If you use a video, it must not be the thing that has to load before the text appears. Text first, always.
- No pop-up in the first 15 seconds. You have not earned it yet.
- The phone number and WhatsApp button stay pinned as the user scrolls. Do not make anyone hunt.

THE 8-SECOND TEST

Show your homepage to someone who knows nothing about the project. After eight seconds, cover the screen and ask: where is it, what does it cost, and what would you tap to find out more? If they cannot answer all three, the hero is wrong — no matter how good it looks.

Page-by-page anatomy

A property site needs fewer pages than you think and more depth on each one than most have.

Page	Must contain	Common mistake
Home	Hero (5 elements), project highlights, location advantage, configurations with prices, gallery preview, trust block, enquiry form, sticky WhatsApp/call	Trying to be a company profile instead of a project pitch
Project detail	Configuration table with carpet area and price, floor plans, master plan, specifications, possession timeline, RERA number and link, payment plan	Renders with no numbers attached
Location	Embedded map, distances to the things buyers actually ask about (school, hospital, airport, metro, workplace hub), connectivity in minutes not kilometres	A decorative map graphic with no real map and no distances
Gallery	Renders, actual construction progress photos with dates, sample flat, amenities	No construction photos — the single biggest trust gap in Indian real estate
About / Trust	Completed projects with delivery years, team, certifications, awards, testimonials with names and photos	Generic stock photos and a mission statement
Contact	Site address with map, sales office timings, phone, WhatsApp, short form	A form and nothing else

What you can safely leave out

- ✗ Blog — unless someone is genuinely going to write it monthly
- ✗ Careers page — a mail-to link is fine until you are 50+ people
- ✗ A separate page for every amenity
- ✗ Chairman's message on the homepage

The enquiry system

This is the part most sites get wrong in a way that is invisible until you look at the numbers. Every field you add is a tax on completion — and every field you ask for should be something your sales team will actually use in the first call.

Form rules

- 01** Four fields maximum on the primary form: name, phone, configuration interest, budget band. Email is optional in Indian real estate — the phone number is the asset.
- 02** Use dropdowns and chips instead of typing wherever possible. Choosing "3 BHK" and "₹80L–1Cr" as taps is far easier one-handed than typing them.
- 03** Never make "Message" a required field. Most people have no message; they have a question they would rather ask on a call.
- 04** Put a short form on every page, not one page. A visitor deep in floor plans should not have to navigate to contact you.
- 05** Set expectations on the button. "Get price list on WhatsApp" converts better than "Submit" because the person knows what they are getting.
- 06** Show a real confirmation. "Thanks Rahul — Priya from our sales team will WhatsApp you within 10 minutes" reduces the chance they immediately fill out a competitor's form.

WhatsApp, done properly

- Pre-fill the message. A click-to-chat link that opens with "Hi, I'm interested in [Project] — please share the price list and floor plans" removes the awkward first-message pause and tells your team instantly which project it is about.
- Use a different pre-filled message per project page so enquiry source is obvious without any tracking setup.
- Put the button in the sticky bar, not just the footer. Thumb-reachable, bottom of the screen.
- Someone must own the number. A WhatsApp button pointing at a phone nobody checks after 7pm is worse than no button — it creates an expectation you then break.
- Consider a WhatsApp Business account for catalogue, away messages and quick replies. The away message alone protects you at night.

Also worth having

- Click-to-call button that works in one tap on mobile
- A downloadable brochure gated behind name + phone — a genuinely useful lead magnet in property
- A "Book a site visit" option with a date picker, for the highest-intent visitors
- Call tracking or at least a separate number for the website, so you can prove where leads came from

The 5-minute rule

The website is not what converts. The first ninety seconds after the form is submitted is what converts.

This section is the highest-return page in this document. Most businesses spend on the site and then let the leads sit. The research on response speed is unusually consistent.

Finding	Source
Responding within 5 minutes makes you around 21× more likely to qualify a lead than responding at 30 minutes	MIT / InsideSales Lead Response Management Study
Roughly 78% of buyers end up working with the first business that responds to their enquiry	NAR Home Buyers & Sellers Trends Report, 2025
Average measured response time to a property enquiry: 917 minutes — over 15 hours. Around 48% of enquiries received no response at all	WAV Group / Weichert study of 384 brokers
Contact odds drop sharply after the first hour	MIT / InsideSales

Note: these studies are US-based, and the specific multipliers get repeated loosely across the industry. Treat the direction as reliable and the exact numbers as indicative — the underlying behaviour (intent decays fast, first responder wins) matches what Indian sales teams see too.

A follow-up sequence that works

When	What happens	Channel
0–60 seconds	Automated WhatsApp: name, project, brochure link, and a promise of a call	Automated
Within 5 minutes	Human call from sales. If unanswered, WhatsApp voice note — not another generic text	Human
Same day	Second call attempt at a different time of day	Human
Day 2	WhatsApp with something new: construction update photo, floor plan, payment plan	Human or automated
Day 4–7	Site visit invitation with two specific slot options	Human
Week 2 onward	Low-frequency value touches — progress photos, price revision notices, possession updates	Automated

MINIMUM VIABLE VERSION

If you do nothing else from this document: connect the form to an instant WhatsApp auto-reply and a notification to a phone someone is actually holding. That single change usually outperforms a full website redesign.

Trust and compliance (India)

In property, trust is not a design flourish — it is the conversion mechanism. And part of it is not optional.

RERA — the non-negotiable part

- Under Section 3 of the RERA Act 2016, a project must be registered before it is advertised, marketed or offered for sale. Your website is advertising.
- The RERA registration number must be displayed on the website and in any advertisement. Several state authorities — UP RERA among them — additionally require a link to the RERA portal alongside the number.
- Section 12 creates liability for false or misleading advertisement. What your website claims is what you are accountable for.
- Projects above 500 sq m or 8 units require registration; marketing an unregistered project is an offence.

This is a general summary, not legal advice — rules and display formats vary by state, so confirm the exact wording your state authority requires before you publish.

Where to put it

- RERA number in the footer of every page
- RERA number and portal link on each project page, near the price
- A small disclaimer block covering render-vs-actual, price revision rights and applicable taxes

Trust signals that actually move people

Signal	Why it works
Dated construction progress photos	The single most convincing thing you can put on a property site. Renders are expected; progress is proof.
Delivered projects with handover years	Turns "are they real" into "they have done this before"
Testimonials with full name, photo and project	Anonymous quotes read as invented
Named sales contact with photo	People call a person more readily than a company
Bank tie-ups / approved loan partners	Signals institutional due diligence has already happened
Physical site office address and timings	Anyone can be visited, therefore anyone is accountable

Speed and mobile

Property sites are the worst offenders for weight: hero videos, uncompressed renders, four font families and a chat widget. Your buyer is on a phone, often on mobile data, often at night.

53%

of mobile visitors abandon a page that takes over 3 seconds

+32%

bounce probability as load time goes from 1s to 3s

2.5s

the Largest Contentful Paint target to aim for

Sources: Google / SOASTA mobile research; Google Core Web Vitals guidance.

Targets to hold your developer to

Metric	Target	How to check
Largest Contentful Paint (mobile)	Under 2.5 seconds	PageSpeed Insights, mobile tab
Total page weight	Under 2 MB for the homepage	Browser dev tools, network tab
Hero image	WebP, under 200 KB, correctly sized	Right-click, inspect
Time to interactive on 4G	Under 5 seconds	PageSpeed Insights throttled test
Mobile usability errors	Zero	Google Search Console

The usual culprits

- × An autoplaying hero video that loads before any text is visible
- × Renders exported at 4000px and displayed at 800px
- × Three chat/analytics widgets loading on every page
- × Image carousels that load all 30 images at once instead of lazily
- × Custom fonts in five weights when two would do

Test your own site on your phone, on mobile data, with the office WiFi off. That is the actual experience of roughly every lead you are trying to win.

Getting found

A property website gets traffic from four places. Build for all four; most sites are built for none.

- 01** Direct project-name searches. Someone saw your hoarding and searched the project name. This is your highest-intent traffic and you should own the first result — make sure the project name is in the page title, the H1 and the URL.
- 02** Locality searches. "3 BHK flats in Gomti Nagar", "new projects on Faizabad Road". This needs a page per locality or per project with the locality named naturally throughout.
- 03** Google Business Profile. Free, badly underused. Add the sales office, real photos, hours, and collect reviews. It often outranks the website for local searches and shows a call button directly.
- 04** Paid and social traffic. Instagram, Meta ads, portals. These need a fast landing page with a matching headline — sending ad traffic to a slow generic homepage wastes the spend.

The basics that get skipped

- A unique page title and meta description per page, with locality and configuration in them
- Schema markup for the organisation and for each project listing
- An OG image so the link looks like a property, not a blank box, when shared on WhatsApp
- Google Search Console and Analytics connected on day one, not month six
- The site submitted and indexed — confirm it, do not assume it

The WhatsApp preview matters more than you think. In Indian real estate, most sharing happens by pasting a link into a family group. Make sure that link unfurls with the project name, a good image and a clear one-liner.

What to prepare before you build

This is why some projects take six weeks and others take an afternoon. The build is fast when the inputs are ready. Gather this material first — whoever builds it, you will get a better site and a faster one.

Brand

- ☐ Logo in vector format (SVG or AI), plus a horizontal version for the header
- ☐ Brand colours as hex codes, not "the blue from our brochure"
- ☐ Fonts you have the right to use on the web
- ☐ How the company name should be written — spacing, capitalisation, any suffix

Project content

- ☐ Project name, locality, full site address and a Google Maps pin
- ☐ Configuration table: type, carpet area, super area, starting price
- ☐ Floor plans and master plan as clean images or PDFs
- ☐ Specifications list — flooring, fittings, structure, safety
- ☐ Amenities list, split into what exists today and what is planned
- ☐ Possession date and current construction stage
- ☐ RERA registration number and the state portal link
- ☐ Payment plan and any active offer
- ☐ Approved bank / loan partners

Media

- ☐ Renders at high resolution — originals, not WhatsApp-compressed copies
- ☐ Dated construction progress photos (the most valuable asset on this list)
- ☐ Sample flat photos if a sample flat exists
- ☐ Locality and connectivity photos
- ☐ Drone or walkthrough video if available, with a still frame as fallback

Sales and operations inputs

- ☐ The WhatsApp number that will receive enquiries — and the person who owns it
- ☐ Sales office address and working hours
- ☐ Who gets notified when a form is submitted, and on what device
- ☐ The exact wording of the automated first reply
- ☐ Which single action the site should push hardest: WhatsApp, call, brochure, or site visit
- ☐ Budget bands you want to offer as form options
- ☐ Configurations you want to offer as form options
- ☐ Where leads should be stored — CRM, Google Sheet, or inbox (decide before launch, not after)

Legal and admin

- ☐ Domain name registered, with access to the DNS panel
- ☐ Hosting decided, or left to whoever builds it — but you should own the account
- ☐ Privacy policy and terms content, or a decision to have them drafted
- ☐ Disclaimer wording for renders, prices and taxes
- ☐ Business email addresses set up on the domain

Own your own assets. Domain, hosting, analytics and the WhatsApp number should all be registered in your name or your company's — not your agency's. This is the single most common way businesses get held hostage by a vendor relationship that has gone cold.

Pre-launch checklist

Run this on a phone, on mobile data, before you announce the site anywhere.

Critical

- ☐ Enquiry form submits successfully and the lead arrives where it is supposed to
- ☐ The automated WhatsApp or SMS reply actually fires, and reads correctly
- ☐ WhatsApp button opens the right number with the right pre-filled message
- ☐ Click-to-call works in one tap on both Android and iPhone
- ☐ RERA number and portal link are visible on every relevant page
- ☐ Every price, area figure and possession date has been checked by the sales head
- ☐ Homepage loads in under 3 seconds on 4G with the office WiFi off
- ☐ The site displays correctly on a small Android phone, not just an iPhone
- ☐ Link preview on WhatsApp shows the correct image, title and description
- ☐ Google Analytics and Search Console are connected and receiving data

Strongly recommended

- ☐ Google Business Profile created or updated with the site link
- ☐ A separate tracking number or UTM setup so website leads are attributable
- ☐ Thank-you page or confirmation state that sets a response-time expectation
- ☐ Construction progress photos dated and captioned
- ☐ Someone assigned to update progress photos monthly
- ☐ 404 page that sends people back to the projects list
- ☐ Backups configured, and you know who holds the login credentials

What to measure after launch

A property website without measurement becomes an expensive brochure within three months. Five numbers, reviewed monthly, are enough.

Metric	What it tells you	Rough guide
Visitors per month, by source	Whether anyone is finding you and from where	Track the trend, not the absolute
Enquiry rate (forms ÷ visitors)	Whether the site converts attention	1–3% is typical; under 0.5% means the hero or form is broken
Response time to first contact	The number that most affects revenue	Target under 5 minutes in working hours
Site visits booked from web leads	Whether the leads are real	The only leading indicator of sales that matters
Cost per booked site visit	Whether paid traffic is worth continuing	Compare across channels, not against a benchmark

A monthly rhythm

- Upload the month's construction progress photos
- Check that the enquiry form and WhatsApp link still work — they break silently after plugin or number changes
- Review response times on last month's leads with the sales team
- Update prices, availability and possession dates
- Read five actual enquiries end to end and ask whether the site set them up well

Lead conversion benchmarks are low by nature in property — industry figures put purchased online leads around 0.4–1.2% conversion and organic or referral leads around 2–5%. Judge your numbers against your own previous months, not against someone else's screenshot.

Hiring someone to build it

Whether you pay ₹10,000 or ₹1,00,000, the questions are the same. The price should follow the scope and the outcome, not the number of hours.

Ask these before you pay

- 01 Will I own the domain, hosting and analytics accounts?
- 02 What exactly happens when someone submits the form — walk me through it end to end.
- 03 What is the mobile load time target, and will you show me the PageSpeed score at handover?
- 04 Can I edit prices, possession dates and progress photos myself, or does every change come back to you?
- 05 What is included in support after launch, and for how long?
- 06 Show me a property site you have built, on your phone, right now.

Red flags

- ✗ The domain will be registered in their name "for convenience"
- ✗ No conversation about what happens after the form is submitted
- ✗ The proposal is a page count with no mention of leads
- ✗ Everything is shown on a laptop and never on a phone
- ✗ Content and photos are treated as your problem entirely, with no guidance on what is needed
- ✗ No PageSpeed or mobile performance commitment at all

Build speed is genuinely no longer the constraint — a good operator with a modern workflow can have a premium property site live the same day. Judge the person on the questions they ask you before they start, not on how fast they promise to finish.

Sources & notes

Figures checked July 2026. Where a statistic is widely repeated across the industry with slightly different framings, the original study is named so you can check it before quoting it to anyone.

Figure used	Origin
5-minute response → ~21× more likely to qualify a lead; ~100× more likely to connect vs 30 minutes	MIT / InsideSales.com Lead Response Management Study
~78% of buyers work with the first business that responds	National Association of Realtors, Home Buyers & Sellers Generational Trends Report 2025 (US)
Average response time of 917 minutes; ~48% of enquiries unanswered	WAV Group / Weichert study across 384 brokers (US)
53% of mobile visitors abandon pages over 3 seconds	Google / SOASTA mobile performance research
Bounce probability up 32% from 1s to 3s load time	Google, Think with Google mobile speed research
LCP under 2.5 seconds as the "good" threshold	Google Core Web Vitals guidance
~75% of people judge credibility on website design	Stanford Web Credibility Research
Lead conversion ~0.4–1.2% (paid online) and ~2–5% (organic/referral)	Industry benchmarks, US real estate 2025–26
RERA: registration required before advertising; registration number must be displayed; liability for false advertisement	Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act 2016, Sections 3 and 12; state authority rules, e.g. UP RERA

Most of the response-time and page-speed research is US-based. The behaviour it describes is not culturally specific, but the exact multipliers should be treated as directional. The RERA summary is general information, not legal advice — state rules differ and change.

THAT'S THE BLUEPRINT

Speed is cheap. Judgement is not.

Every tool in this document is available to everyone now. A website can be live before lunch. What still separates a site that sits there from a site that fills a sales diary is the set of decisions in these thirteen sections — and almost all of them are made before anyone opens a design tool.

Start with Section 10. Gather the material. Everything after that gets easier, faster and cheaper — whoever builds it.

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If you work through this and something does not fit your project, tell me what — the awkward cases are how the next version of this gets written.

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